

SCRATCH JR

MAKE IT MOVE!

Fun, Creative & Easy Coding for Young Learners!

A beginner-friendly lesson for ages 5–8

■ **Duration:** 45–60 minutes

■ **Platform:** Tablet / iPad / Android

■ **Goal:** Learn to animate characters with code blocks

■ **Key Concepts:** Sequence, Loops, Creativity

1. WHAT IS CODING?

Coding is giving a computer a set of instructions — just like telling a friend step-by-step how to play a game! The computer follows every instruction exactly as you give it. The great news?

Anyone can learn to code — even you!

- Computers do exactly what you tell them — no more, no less.
- Instructions must be clear and in the right order.
- Coding lets you create games, stories, and animations.
- You do not need to know maths to start — just imagination!

2. MEET SCRATCH JR!

Scratch Jr is a **free app** where children can create stories and games by coding. It is designed for ages 5–7 and uses colourful drag-and-drop blocks — no typing required!

- **Website:** www.scratchjr.org
- **Download:** Free on App Store & Google Play
- **Best for:** Ages 5–8 (Kindergarten – Grade 2)
- **Works on:** iPad, Android tablet, Chromebook

3. WHY LEARN CODING?

- **Problem-solving:** Breaks big challenges into small steps.
- **Creativity:** Express ideas through animations and stories.
- **Tech literacy:** Understand the devices around us.
- **Confidence:** See your creation come alive!
- **Fun:** Learning feels like playing a game.

4. CODING BLOCKS IN SCRATCH JR

Each colourful block tells your character what to do. Drag and drop them to build your code!

■ Move

Walk forward or backward across the screen.

■ Turn

Spin your character left or right.

■■ Jump

Make your character leap up and come back down.

■ Sound

Play a fun sound effect.

■ Repeat

Do an action again and again — called a LOOP!

■ Start (Green Flag)

Begin your program when the green flag is pressed.

5. HOW TO MAKE YOUR CHARACTER MOVE

- 1 Open Scratch Jr on your tablet or device.

Tap on your favourite character to select it.

- 3 Drag the "Move Forward" block to the coding area.

Connect the block to the green flag block.

- 5 Press the green flag — and watch it move! ■

■ **Teacher Tip:** Demonstrate on the board first, then let students try. Encourage them to press the flag multiple times and observe what happens!

6. SEQUENCES — CHAINING BLOCKS TOGETHER

A **sequence** is a set of instructions given in a specific order. In Scratch Jr, you create sequences by connecting blocks one after another. Try these two sequences with your students:

Sequence 1: Move & Turn!	Sequence 2: Jump & Sound!
Move Forward → Turn → Move Forward Drag the move block, then a turn block, then move again. Your character walks and looks a new way!	Jump → Move Forward → Sound Make your character jump, walk forward, then play a fun sound. Put blocks together to create cool actions!

7. REPEAT & LOOPS!

A **loop** is a way to repeat an action multiple times without adding the same block over and over. Scratch Jr has a special **Repeat block** that wraps around other blocks and runs them again and again!

- The Repeat block wraps around your move blocks.
- Move Forward + Repeat = keeps going and going!
- Loops make your code shorter and smarter.
- Try: Repeat a Turn block 4 times — what shape does your character trace?

8. FUN CODING IDEAS TO TRY!

Use these project ideas to inspire young coders. Let their imagination run wild!

- ■ Make your character dance to music!
- ■■ Create a mini race game with friends!
- ■ Show your character exploring a jungle!
- ■■ Make it rain with cool sound effects!
- ■ Build a story with two characters!
- ■ Make your character jump and spin!

9. TIPS FOR BEING CREATIVE

- Try new characters — animals, kids, fantasy creatures!
- Mix sounds and movements together for surprising results.
- Tell a story: give your character a beginning, middle, and end.
- Share your creations with friends and classmates.
- Experiment! There are no wrong answers in Scratch Jr.

10. SUMMARY — WHAT DID WE LEARN?

- Coding means giving clear instructions to a computer.
- Scratch Jr uses colourful drag-and-drop blocks.
- Blocks make characters move, turn, jump, and make sounds.
- Sequences chain blocks together for multi-step actions.
- Repeat blocks create loops that run actions again and again.
- Creativity makes coding super fun!

11. WHERE TO TRY SCRATCH JR

- **Website:** Visit scratchjr.org to explore the app and tutorials.
- **Download:** Free on the App Store (iOS) or Google Play (Android).
- **Tutorials:** Find beginner tutorials on the Scratch Jr website.
- **Videos:** Watch how-to videos online together with a parent.
- **Getting started:** Ask your teacher or parent to download the app and set up your first project!

■ KEEP CODING! ■

You are now a coding superstar!

Keep exploring and have fun with Scratch Jr!